Subclass 500

Student visa

Visit Australia to participate in a course of study.

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With this visa you can

- participate in an eligible course of study in Australia
- travel in and out of Australia
- work up to 48 hours a fortnight when your course of study or training is in session (students studying a master's by research or doctoral degree, and their families, have no work limit).

How long you can stay

Ask a question

This is a temporary visa to study up to 6 years. The type of course and its length will determine the length of stay *(/visas/getting-a-visa/visa-listing/student-500/length-of-stay)*

Primary school children starting their enrolment in years 1-4 will generally only be granted a Student visa for a maximum period of 3 years.

Cost

The visa costs from AUD2,500.00 for the main applicant (concessions apply in limited circumstances).

There is also a charge for each family member who applies for the visa.

You might also have to pay other costs for:

- health checks
- police certificates
- biometrics.

To work out what your visa will cost, use the Visa Pricing Estimator *(/visas/visa-pricing-estimator)*. The estimator does not take into account the other costs.

Cost concession

A lower visa cost applies to eligible Pacific Island and Timor-Leste citizens and eligible ASEAN (Association of Southeast Asian Nations) citizens who lodge a valid Student visa application.

We will charge eligible applicants the lower visa application cost during the application process in ImmiAccount *(https://online.immi.gov.au/lusc/login)*. We will recognise eligible applicants by the valid passport from the specified countries used in the application when they apply.

Family members are also eligible for the lower visa cost. We base this on the passport of the primary applicant (or visa holder who satisfies the primary visa criteria).

Pacific Island and Timor-Leste citizen primary applicants must hold a valid passport issued by one of the following countries:

- Federated States of Micronesia
- Fiji
- Kiribati
- Nauru
- Palau
- Papua New Guinea
- Republic of the Marshall Islands
- Samoa
- Solomon Islands
- Timor-Leste
- Tonga
- Tuvalu
- Vanuatu

ASEAN citizens primary applicants must hold a valid passport issued by one of the following countries:

- Brunei Darussalam

- Cambodia
- Indonesia
- Lao Peoples Dem Republic
- Malaysia
- Myanmar
- Philippines
- Singapore
- Thailand
- Timor-Leste (note that the applicable cost for Timor-Leste citizens will be applied according to the cost for Pacific Island and Timor-Leste citizens rather than ASEAN citizens)
- Vietnam

A lower visa cost also applies to valid Student visa applications in the Independent ELICOS and Non-Awards Sector.

Stay longer

From 2 October 2026, new rules apply to current Student visa holders who want to lodge another Student visa application while in Australia.

Most Student visa holders can no longer apply for a further Student visa in Australia.

If you hold a student visa you can only apply in Australia if you meet an exemption. If you do not meet an exemption category *(/visas/getting-a-visa/visa-listing/student-500#Eligibility)*, you must apply from outside Australia.

If you hold a Student visa but are no longer eligible to apply for another Student visa while in Australia, you will need to lodge your next application from outside Australia.

Applications lodged before 2 October 2026 will continue to be assessed under the rules that were in place when they were lodged. This includes applications that included family members.

If your Student visa will expire before your graduation, you might be eligible for a Visitor visa (subclass 600) *(/visas/getting-a-visa/visa-listing/visitor-600)*. You will need a letter from your education provider with the date of your graduation.

If you hold or held a Student visa and completed specific qualifications in Australia in the last six months, you might be eligible for a Temporary Graduate visa (subclass 485) *(/visas/getting-a-visa/visa-listing/temporary-graduate-485/)*.

If you want to stay longer for other reasons, you must apply for a new visa that suits your circumstances. Explore your visa options *(/visas/getting-a-visa/visa-finder)*.

Include family in some circumstances

From 2 October 2026, new rules apply to including family members in Student visa applications.

Most Student visa applicants can no longer include family members. This also applies to people applying for a further Student visa.

If you submitted your application before **2 October 2026**, we will assess it under the rules that were in place on the date you applied. This also applies to applications that included family members.

You cannot include family members (partners and children) in your Student visa application lodged unless you meet an exemption category *(/visas/getting-a-visa/visa-listing/student-500#Eligibility)*.

Your family members cannot apply as a **subsequent entrant** (at a later time, separate from your application) **in any circumstance.**

For Student visas, your family member is:

- your partner, or
- your or your partner's dependent child who is unmarried and has not turned 18 years of age.

We cannot grant a Student visa to your child if they have turned 18 years at the time your visa is finalised. They need to apply for their own visa.

Newborn child

If you have a child while holding a Student visa or while your Student visa application is being processed, different arrangements apply depending on where the child is born.

- Child born in Australia: The child automatically holds the same visa as their parent
- Child born in Australia: The primary applicant can include the child in a further student visa application lodged in Australia if they are eligible to apply and include family in Australia under an exemption category.
- Child born outside Australia while a Student visa application is being processed: The primary applicant can include the child in the application before a decision is made, provided they meet an exemption category to include family members.

Find out what to do if you have a child *(/change-in-situation/had-a-baby)*.

Family members who apply for the visa must meet our requirements for health *(/help-support/meeting-our-requirements/health)* and character *(/help-support/meeting-our-requirements/character)*.

For more information about if you are eligible to include family members in your application, see **Meet an exemption if you want to include family members on the Eligibility page**.

Check the annual school costs you will need to pay for any dependent children to go to either public or private schools in Australia.

For more information see 'Evidence you have enough money for your stay' section under Gather documents *(/visas/getting-a-visa/visa-listing/student-500#HowTo)*.

Apply from

From 2 October 2026, most Student visa applications must be lodged outside Australia.

Most applicants must apply from outside Australia. You can only apply in Australia if you:

- hold an eligible visa
- meet an exemption category.

If you do not hold an eligible visa and meet an exemption category, you must apply from outside Australia and be outside Australia when we grant the visa. For more information about who can apply in Australia, see **Apply from the right location** and **Meet an exemption to apply for a further student visa in Australia** on the Eligibility tab *(/visas/getting-a-visa/visa-listing/student-500#Eligibility)*.

Packaged courses

You will need to give us Confirmation of Enrolment (CoE) for each course. The last course you take as part of the course package is your main course of study. We use your main course of study to work out what financial and English language skills evidence you must give us.

If your visa application includes a package of courses, course gaps must be less than two calendar months, unless the first course finishes at the end of the standard academic year and the next course commences at the beginning of the standard academic year.

For example, the academic year generally ends in November and starts again in February the following year, three to four months is an acceptable gap between courses.

Standard visa grant periods apply to packaged courses.

If you are a student visa holder and you meet an exemption to lodge a further Student visa in Australia, you cannot package courses together unless you are applying for:

- primary or secondary school studies or
- a further visa because your education provider defaulted.

Processing times

Make sure you allow plenty of time to prepare your application. Applications can take longer to process during peak periods, so lodge well in advance of your course start date.

Your application can take longer to process if:

- you do not fill it in correctly
- you do not include all the documents we need or we need more information from you
- it takes us time to verify your information.

Find out what you can do to help us process your application faster *(/visas/getting-a-visa/check-twice-submit-once)*.

We can't process your application if you do not pay the correct visa application charge. We will tell you if this applies to you.

For more information about student visa processing times, see Student visa processing priorities *(/visas/getting-a-visa/visa-processing-times/visa-processing-priorities/student-visa)*.

Your obligations

You and your family must meet all visa conditions and follow Australian laws.

See which conditions will and might be attached to this visa. *(/visas/already-have-a-visa/check-visa-details-and-conditions/see-your-visa-conditions?product=500)*

Travel

You can travel outside Australia and return as many times as you want while the visa is valid.

The time you spend outside Australia does not extend the visa.

Visa label

We will digitally link your visa to your passport. You will not get a label in your passport.

Visa scams

Don't get caught in visa scams. For details refer to visa scams *(/help-support/visa-scams)*.

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